

Basic Formulas

Learning Objectives

- Write formulas using addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division
- Use the equals sign to start formulas
- Understand the difference between formula and value

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a vegetable vendor who adds up daily sales manually-adding, subtracting, and multiplying on paper. Formulas in a spreadsheet do this instantly. Type the formula once, and the answer appears automatically. No more mental math errors!

Explore (10-12 minutes)

In a new spreadsheet, enter 100 in A1, 250 in B1, and 150 in C1. In D1, type =A1+B1 to add. In D2, type =B1-A1 to subtract. In D3, type =A1*2 to multiply. In D4, type =B1/5 to divide. Note how changing values in A1 automatically updates the formulas.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Formulas always start with = sign. Basic operators are + (add), - (subtract), * (multiply), / (divide). Cell references (like A1) are used instead of numbers, so when data changes, results update automatically. This is the power of spreadsheets – dynamic calculations without rewriting formulas.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a bill for a kirana store. List 5 items with prices in column A and quantities in column B. In column C, write formulas to calculate total for each item (=A1*B1). In cell C7, write a formula to find the grand total of all items. Change one price and observe the total update.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Answer: Why do formulas start with =? What happens to C7 when you change a value in A1? Write the formula to calculate 15% tax on a total in cell D1.